# Incident Report: Brute Force

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| **Date/time** | 2026-10-08 / 21:38 |
| **Analyst** | SD |
| **Severity** | High |
| **Status** | Closed (lab) |

## Summary

An attacker launched a brute-force SSH attack from a Kali machine against the lab endpoint (192.168.56.108). Wazuh detected repeated authentication failures and generated an alert within seconds, correctly flagging the activity before any valid credentials were found

## Detection

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| **Tool** | Wazuh |
| **Rule ID and description** | 5760 - sshd: authentication failed. |
| **Alert time** | 21:38 |

## Timeline

| Time | Event |
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| 21:38 | Hydra brute force launched from Kali against port 22 |
| 21:38 | Wazuh rule 5760 triggered on repeated auth failures |
| 21:39 | Attack confirmed unsuccessful; no valid credentials found |

## Evidence

***Image 1***: Terminal output on Kali showing the Hydra brute force attempt against the endpoint, completed with 0 valid passwords found.

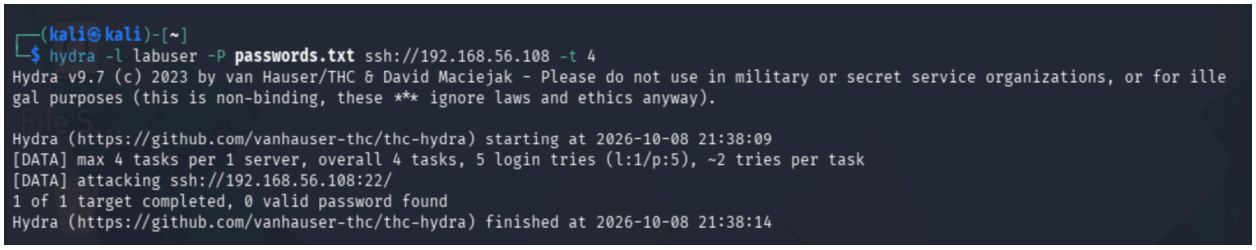
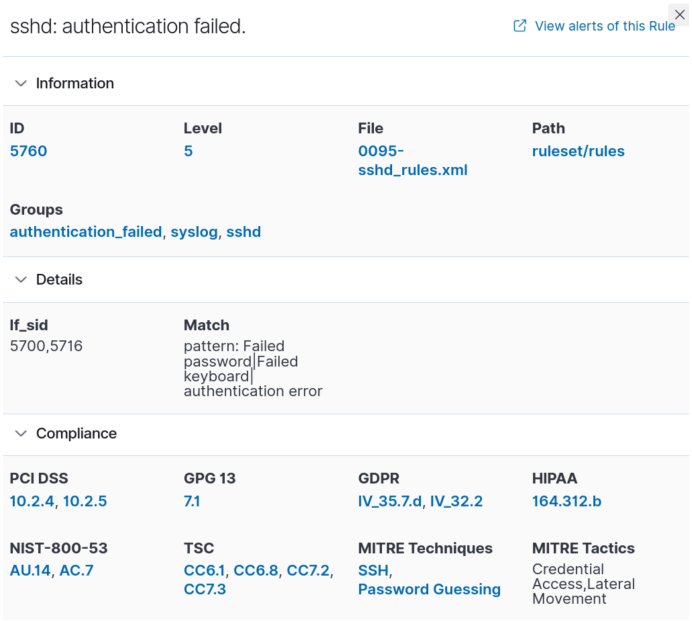


***Image 2***: Wazuh alert detail for rule 576, confirming detection at level 5 with MITRE ATT&CK Credential Access / Lateral Movement tactics and Password Guessing technique, plus compliance mapping to PCI DSS, NIST 800-53, GDPR, and HIPAA.




## MITRE ATT&CK

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| **Tactic** | Credential Access |
| **Technique** | T1110 Brute Force (T1110.001 Password Guessing) |

## Analysis

This is a **true positive**. The alert matched the attack window exactly and correctly identified repeated failed SSH logins as a brute force pattern. Wazuh's default ruleset caught this without custom tuning, showing solid out-of-the-box detection coverage for credential attacks in this environment.
This alert also maps to recognized compliance frameworks, including NIST 800-53 (AU-14, AC-7) and PCI DSS (10.2.4, 10.2.5), both of which require monitoring of failed authentication attempts. As the account-creation finding, this shows the detection supports audit and compliance reporting, not just SOC alerting.

## Response Recommendations

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| **Immediate action** | Review the source IP and consider a temporary block if seen outside the lab network |

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| **Long-term fix** | Enable active response in Wazuh to auto-block an IP after N failed attempts, and move SSH to key-based authentication only |

## Lessons Learned

Default Wazuh rules detected this attack type with no extra configuration. The main gap is response, detection alone does not stop the attack, so pairing this with active response would close the loop.